

Static Ads Generator

Full Execution Playbook — start to finish

Internal operator runbook · Creative Adbundance

This is the complete process for producing on-brand static ad creatives for a client, from the moment they sign on to delivering finished ads. It is written from the operator's seat: what you do, in what order, and the hard-won rules that make it actually work.

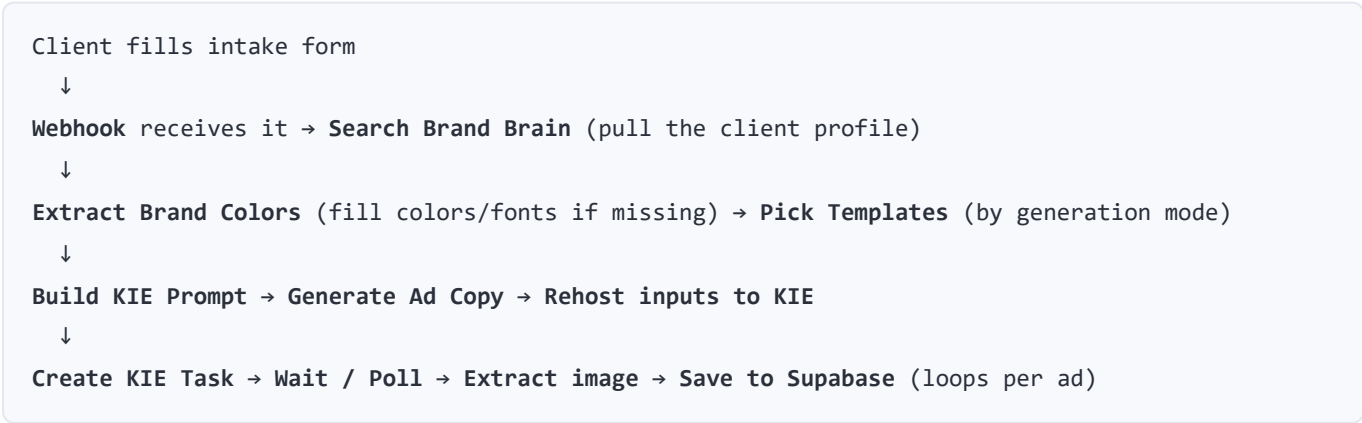
1. What the system does

A client submits a short intake form. An automation (n8n) pulls that client's brand profile and a set of proven ad templates, writes on-brand ad copy, and renders finished ad images with an AI image model (KIE AI). The output is a batch of ready-to-review static ads that match the client's brand colors, fonts, voice, and winning formats. You review, pick the keepers, and deliver.

2. The stack

Tool	Role
Intake form	Where the client submits the brief, references, product images, and generation mode.
Airtable — Brand Brain	The single source of truth per client: voice, offer, audience, colors, fonts, logo, winning ads. The brain that feeds every ad.
n8n	The engine. Orchestrates the whole flow from webhook to finished image.
OpenRouter	Writes the ad copy and reads references (gpt-4o for vision, Claude for text).
KIE AI	Renders the actual ad image (<code>gpt-image-2-image-to-image</code>) and hosts input images.
Supabase	Storage for uploads (products, references) and finished output.

3. The big picture (the flow)



4. Phase 1 — Onboarding and intake

1. **Run the kickoff / creative brief.** Capture goal, channels, audience, offer, product lines, competitors, dos and donts, and any hard rules (for example, "real talent only, no AI avatars").
2. **Collect assets:** logo, brand guidelines if any, top-performing past ads ("winning ads"), and product images for product brands.
3. **The intake form** sends: client name, brief, generation mode, any uploaded references, product images, and an optional UGC avatar.

5. Phase 2 — Build the Brand Brain (most important step)

The quality of every ad is decided here. One Airtable row per client, filled from the brief plus live research off their website.

Fields to fill

Field	What goes in it
client_name / brand_name	Main name plus any sister-brand name (some brands are looked up by sister name).
website	Their URL. This drives the automated color and font scrape below.
industry, brand_tone, brand_personality	Who they are and how they should sound.
key_offer, core_pain_points, product_benefits	The selling points and the problems they solve.
target_personas	Who the ads are for, per segment.
competitors, creative_boundaries, dos_and_donts	Guardrails. This is where "no AI talent", "no random props", etc. live.
primary / secondary / accent_color_hex	Brand colors (auto-scraped, see below).
brand_fonts	Brand typefaces (auto-scraped, see below).
logo_urls, winning_ads, product_image	Attachments: logo, the client's best ads, products.

Auto-fill brand colors and fonts from the website

Do not eyeball colors off a logo. Scrape the live site, it carries the full real palette and typefaces and never expires. The scraper fetches the homepage plus its CSS, ranks the real brand colors (dropping neutral greys, white, and black), and pulls the fonts from Google Fonts links, `@font-face`, and the most-used `font-family`. It writes `primary / secondary / accent_color_hex` and `brand_fonts` straight into Airtable.

Why this beats the logo: a logo is often one or two colors and lives on Airtable (which expires). The website gives primary, supporting, and accent colors plus the actual fonts, from a URL that stays alive.

6. Phase 3 — Choose the generation mode

Mode	Uses	Behavior
top_performers (default)	Proven CreativeOS template library	Loose blueprint. 3 copy angles each (pain / benefit / trust). Best when the client has no strong references of their own.
team_top5	The client's own <code>winning_ads</code>	Close reproduction of their best ads, swapped onto current brand. 1 variant each, uses all winners.
user_reference	References the client uploaded this run	Close reproduction. Keep the concept, swap only the brand/object. This is the highest-value mode.

Rule: if a reference is uploaded, it is always used (it auto-routes to close-reproduction). Keep the concept device; swap only the object and brand; match the original's plainness (do not add a logo box or CTA the original did not have).

7. Phase 4 — Run the pipeline (what each stage does)

Stage	What it does
1 Webhook	Receives the form submission and kicks off the run.
2 Search Brand Brain	Pulls the client's row (matches on client name or sister brand name).
3 Extract Brand Colors	If colors are already in the brain, uses them. If not, scrapes the website and fills primary/secondary/accent on the fly.
4 Pick Templates	Routes by generation mode: winners, references, or the CreativeOS library.
5 Build KIE Prompt	Builds the image prompt per template and angle: template as blueprint, brand colors and fonts enforced, product/logo/avatar placed, photoreal render style for human-service brands, guardrails applied.
6 Generate Ad Copy	Writes headline, subline, CTA, and brand-derived design elements. For references, reads the image to copy the concept.
7 Rehost inputs to KIE	Uploads every Airtable image (template, logo, winners) to KIE so it gets a permanent, fetchable URL. Critical, see gotchas.
8 Create KIE Task	Sends the prompt plus input images to KIE to render the ad.
9 Wait / Poll	Polls KIE until the image is ready.
10 Extract + Save	Grabs the finished image URL and saves it to Supabase. Loops for the next ad.

8. Phase 5 — The gotchas that make it work

These are the lessons that took the most time. Honor them and the pipeline runs clean.

Airtable image URLs expire (about 2 hours)

Templates, logos, and winning ads live on Airtable, and those links die fast. If KIE tries to fetch an expired link it fails with "Image fetch failed" or a 410. **Fix:** rehost every Airtable image to KIE within the same fresh run (the Rehost stage), then feed KIE its own permanent URLs.

Rehosted files need a real file extension

KIE names a rehosted file from the source URL. Airtable URLs have no extension, so the file lands with none and KIE rejects it ("File type not supported"). **Fix:** pass an explicit filename ending in `.png` when rehosting.

Reading an Airtable image with AI

Anthropic/Claude cannot fetch Airtable images (blocked by robots). **Fix:** use `openai/gpt-4o` for any vision read of an Airtable asset, or rehost to KIE first and read that.

Testing a single node uses stale data

When you run one node in isolation, it uses the last cached input, so Airtable URLs are already expired. **Fix:** re-run Search Brand Brain first to refresh the links, or run the whole flow from the trigger.

Creative direction by brand type

For human-service brands (health, tutoring, etc.), push photoreal editorial photography and real people. Ban flat vector icons, clip-art, and decorative blobs. Match the template's structure, not its pixels.

9. Phase 6 — Review and deliver

1. Finished ads land in Supabase output. Review against the brief and brand.
2. Pick the keepers; flag any that drifted off-brand (wrong colors, fabricated text, off-concept).
3. Deliver for client review (statics via Figma in current workflow).
4. Log what worked and what failed so the next batch improves.

10. New client quick-start checklist

Step	Done when
1. Kickoff + creative brief captured	Goal, audience, offer, guardrails written down
2. Brand Brain row created	Name, website, voice, offer, audience, guardrails filled
3. Colors + fonts scraped from website	primary/secondary/accent_color_hex + brand_fonts populated
4. Assets uploaded	Logo, winning ads, product images in Airtable
5. Generation mode chosen	top_performers, team_top5, or user_reference decided
6. Test run	One full pass through the pipeline, output looks on-brand
7. Batch + review + deliver	Keepers selected and sent for client review

That is the full execution. Set up the Brand Brain well, respect the gotchas, and the system delivers on-brand static ads at volume for any new client.